

Joint Statement on Supporting Medical Innovation, Entrepreneurship and Enterprise for Australian Medical School Graduates

July 2025

Preamble

Australia's health system depends on continual innovation to improve patient outcomes, address unmet needs, strengthen healthcare delivery and tackle growing fiscal challenges.

Medical graduates are uniquely positioned to identify challenges and opportunities to drive advances in healthcare through the development of new health technologies, models of care and innovative healthcare enterprises. Examples of doctor-led innovations include Professor Graeme Clark's cochlear implant, Professor Fiona Wood's spray-on skin and Professor Ian Frazer's cervical cancer vaccine. Renowned Australian companies such as CSL, ProMedicus and Sonic Healthcare have also been founded or led by medical graduates delivering long-term economic benefits and strengthening Australia's global position as a leader in healthcare innovation.

This Joint Statement has been initiated and coordinated by Dr Brandon Carp, President of the Australian Society for Medical Entrepreneurship and Innovation (ASME) in collaboration with Australia's medical school leaders.

Statement of Agreement

We acknowledge the importance of graduates applying their skills not only in clinical practice but also in innovation, entrepreneurship, and enterprise.

We recognise their potential to develop new health solutions, strengthen our health system, improve global health outcomes and be an economic growth engine for Australia.

We appreciate the value of equipping medical graduates with skills in innovation, enterprise and emerging developments to help improve healthcare outcomes.

Commitments

To that end we collectively support:

- Recognising medical innovation, entrepreneurship, and enterprise as valid career pathways for graduates.
- Exploring opportunities to incorporate awareness, exposure and education of these areas during training.